cause of the unsustainable state of the planet and grossly unequal distribution of income and wealth on account of the ‘profit’ chased and generated by the corporations by socializing all environmental and social costs to the people.

The real ESG agenda is to balance the interests of people, planet and profit.

## *ESG Agenda is Still Not Well Defined*

There are three key components of the ESG agenda: environmental, social and governance. All three dimensions have seen lot of action in the past fifty years but are still to be defined clearly and fully.

The environmental agenda has two parts: climate change and pollution.

The climate change ambition is quite well articulated by now: the net-zero carbon addition to the atmosphere by 2050 to restrict the rise in global temperatures to less than 2 per cent over pre-industrial era average global temperatures. Climate change is a global issue and has rightly become a global concern. However, what it would take to become a net-zero carbon emission world is not fully understood and agreed upon.

The pollution issue is both global and local. Pollution of oceans has turned out to be a global issue. Air pollution is more local, but there are trans-boundary flows of air pollution as well. Likewise, pollution of rivers and water systems has a more regional element. In many countries, pollution is a more pressing issue than climate change. The global agenda on pollution, which was the principal focus of the Stockholm Conference, is losing international play. Carbon has taken over the global pollution agenda. Most of the world still has massive pollution problems on its hands. Pollution needs to regain prominence in the environmental agenda.

On a macro level, the social agenda is moving in the opposite direction. The digital technology revolution has reduced the need for labour and replaced many labour-driven services. There is much more inequality in the